

Journey & Empathy Map Template

Design Thinking — Empathy & Experience Mapping

Context

Persona / User

Ananya the Academic

Scenario / Goal

Managing academic pressure while struggling with self-doubt and emotional burnout.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 — Academic Pressure	Stage 2 — Burnout & Self-Doubt	Stage 3 — Healthy Balance	Stage Name...	Stage Name...
Scene / Event Upload picture				Upload Camera Add a representative image	Upload Camera Add a representative image
Actions What do they do?	Studies continuously Avoids breaks Compares herself to others	Overthinks mistakes Sleeps less Withdraws socially	Creates schedules Takes breaks Talks openly about stress	User actions...	User actions...
Touchpoints Channels & Tools	Books Online classes Parents Teachers	Academic results Competitive peers Social media	Productivity apps Friends Counselors	Channels/Tools...	Channels/Tools...
Thoughts Internal mental state	"I can't fail." "Everyone is better than me."	"What if I disappoint everyone?" "I'm not good enough."	"Progress matters more than perfection." "I can do this step by step."	Internal mental state...	Internal mental state...
Says Key Quotes	"I need to study more."	"I'm just tired."	"I'm trying to balance things better."	"Quotes"...	"Quotes"...
Feels Emotions & State	Stressed Overwhelmed Burnt out	Anxious Insecure Emotionally exhausted	Calm Motivated More confident	Emotions...	Emotions...
Emotion Score -10 to +10	-8	-5	8	8	8
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	Fear of failure Lack of confidence Mental exhaustion	Low self-esteem Comparison stress No emotional support	Fear of returning to burnout	Frictions...	Frictions...
Opportunities Ideas for improvement	Stress management tools Mentorship support Wellness counseling	Peer study communities Mental health awareness Time management systems	Academic wellness programs Positive support systems	Solutions...	Solutions...

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Rahul the Relocator

Adjusting to a completely new environment while dealing with loneliness and emotional burnout.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 — Relocation & Isolation	Stage 2 — Trying to Adjust	Stage 3 — Rebuilding Connection	Stage Name...	Stage Name...
Scene / Event Upload picture				Upload Camera Add a representative image	Upload Camera Add a representative image
Actions What do they do?	Avoids social interaction Scrolls social media Thinks about old friends Listens to music alone	Joins online groups Talks to classmates/colleagues Explores nearby places	Meets people regularly Opens up emotionally Participates in activities	User actions...	User actions...
Touchpoints Channels & Tools	Phone Instagram Family members Old friends online	WhatsApp groups College/workplace Cafes and local events	Supportive friends Community spaces Wellness platforms	Channels/Tools...	Channels/Tools...
Thoughts Internal mental state	"Nobody understands me here." "I miss my old life."	"Maybe I can start over." "I want real friends again."	"Things are finally improving." "I feel less alone now."	Internal mental state...	Internal mental state...
Says Key Quotes	"I'm fine." "I just need time."	"I'll try being more social."	"I'm happier than before."	"Quotes"...	"Quotes"...
Feels Emotions & State	Lonely Restless Emotionally drained	Nervous Hopeful Unsure	Connected Comfortable More confident	Emotions...	Emotions...
Emotion Score -10 to +10	-7	1	7	8	8
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	No support system Emotional isolation Difficulty adjusting	Fear of rejection Social anxiety Overthinking conversations	Fear of losing connections again	Frictions...	Frictions...
Opportunities Ideas for Improvement	Local community events Peer support groups Mental wellness apps	Friendship matching apps Hobby clubs Counseling support	Long-term support communities Healthy routine building	Solutions...	Solutions...

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Rohan the Socialite

Trying to build authentic relationships while hiding loneliness behind social media activity.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 — Online Validation	Stage 2 — Relationship Conflicts	Stage 3 — Authentic Connections	Stage Name...	Stage Name...
Scene / Event Upload picture				Upload Camera Add a representative image	Upload Camera Add a representative image
Actions What do they do?	Posts constantly Checks likes and messages Attends social events	Overchecks messages Questions people's intentions Avoids vulnerability	Limits social media use Spends quality time offline Builds honest conversations	User actions...	User actions...
Touchpoints Channels & Tools	Instagram Snapchat Friends Dating apps	Partner Friends Social media chat	Close friends Community meetups Wellness communities	Channels/Tools...	Channels/Tools...
Thoughts Internal mental state	"Why do I still feel lonely?" "Do people actually care?"	"Nobody is genuine." "I'm tired of fake connections."	"Real connection matters more." "I feel understood now."	Internal mental state...	Internal mental state...
Says Key Quotes	"I'm always busy."	"I don't trust easily anymore."	"I don't need validation anymore."	"Quotes"...	"Quotes"...
Feels Emotions & State	Empty Insecure Lonely	Frustrated Confused Emotionally distant	Happy Secure Emotionally connected	Emotions...	Emotions...
Emotion Score -10 to +10					
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	Fake relationships Social comparison Lack of trust	Communication gaps Fear of betrayal Emotional instability	Happy Secure Emotionally connected	Frictions...	Frictions...
Opportunities Ideas for improvement	Digital wellness support Authentic social communities	Relationship counseling Trust-building communication tools	Long-term emotional support Offline social activities	Solutions...	Solutions...